

James Holliss

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PROFILE - 10+ YEARS OF CONSULTING, ENGINEERING, AND COMMERCIAL EXPERIENCE

AI Expert and Solutions Engineer with a track record of leading large transformation programmes, and architecting, building and deploying production-grade agentic AI platforms and automation solutions in regulated environments.

Combines deep technical expertise across LLM orchestration, MCP-based enterprise integration, process automation, and agentic workflow design with strong commercial instincts and C-level stakeholder engagement.

Experienced in identifying operational inefficiencies and turning them into working automations across back office functions in regulated environments. Brings a pragmatic, delivery-focused approach: identify the inefficiency, design the solution, ship it fast, measure the impact.

EXPERIENCE

Solutions Engineer — AI & Integration • SnapLogic | Nov 2025 – Present

- › Design and deploy enterprise agentic AI architectures using MCP-enabled agent orchestration, agentic RAG pipelines, and event-driven API ecosystems across regulated financial services environments.
- › Built SnapLogic's internal AI, a production-grade enterprise AI agent platform connecting 50+ systems via MCP protocol; automating complex multi-step workflows with full technical and cost auditability, with human in the loop features.
- › Delivered end-to-end KYC/AML process automation for a UK Bank — 5x throughput for the same number of people.
- › Lead high-impact Proofs of Concept, identifying process inefficiencies and translating them into scalable AI-driven automation platforms across hybrid-cloud environments.
- › Established trusted advisor relationships with C-level stakeholders; partner with sales & product to implement AI.

Managing Consultant • Praesto Consulting | Sep 2024 – Nov 2025

- › Led large Finance, Data & CRM Transformations across global enterprise organisations; engaged C-level stakeholders across banking, insurance, and financial services on data, CRM, and AI-driven automation programmes.
- › Drove internal AI adoption strategy: established frameworks for responsible LLM use, identified automation opportunities, and led PoCs demonstrating measurable operational efficiency gains.
- › Managed multiple simultaneous enterprise-scale finance transformation and data projects from RFI through delivery.

Lead Solutions Engineer — Data & AI, Central Government • Civica | Apr 2023 – Sep 2024

- › Owned Data, AI & Analytics for central government; delivered £6m revenue across MoD, MoJ, Home Office, and DfT.
- › Created Civica's AI in Government go-to-market strategy — a new capability area for the business — including solution architecture, automation use cases, demos, and commercial models.
- › Led AI readiness assessments and pre-sales engagements; identified automation opportunities and translated complex public sector data challenges into actionable AI adoption roadmaps.

Principal Consultant • Praesto Consulting | Oct 2017 – Apr 2023

- › Led finance transformation programmes across banking, telecoms, insurance, and aerospace — covering back office functions including FP&A, Treasury, and Regulatory Reporting — full lifecycle from RFI through delivery.
- › Automated previously manual finance processes across multinational clients: budgeting, account reconciliation, master data management, and management reporting workflows.
- › Designed finance technology strategies for multinationals; built and managed multi-disciplinary project teams.

Freelance Engineer | 2014 – 2017

- › Audio Engineer for television, film and music. Award-winning entertainment/sports. BBC, ITV, C4 & Sky.

KEY PROJECTS

Enterprise Agentic AI Platform | SnapLogic · Production deployment

- › Built from the ground up: a fully agentic AI orchestration platform accessible via Slack, Microsoft Teams, and email, connecting 40+ enterprise systems through MCP protocol.
- › Automates complex multi-step workflows across systems — from data retrieval and processing through to drafting, routing, and action execution — with a human approval layer for any write operations.
- › Massive efficiency gains for SnapLogic Sales. ROI on LLM token spend is 37x, 3700%.
- › Designed with governance at its core: full audit trail of every request, tool call, token usage, and cost; evidence-of-control at every automated decision point.

KYC/AML Process Automation — UK Bank | SnapLogic · Regulated banking deployment

- › Automated end-to-end KYC and AML checks — replacing manual document review and compliance processing with AI-powered extraction, classification, and intelligent routing integrated with existing bank systems.
- › Enabled 5x throughput for loan applications with the same number staff while improving consistency, speed, and auditability of outcomes.
- › Maintained full regulatory compliance through evidence-of-control audit trails and human review gates at key decision points, preserving the oversight required in regulated workflows.

Finance Systems Transformation — International Airport | Praesto Consulting · Full lifecycle delivery

- › Led the end-to-end implementation of three integrated finance systems covering budgeting, account reconciliation, and master data management — from RFI and solution architecture through commercial modelling and go-live.
- › Automated previously manual finance processes including month-end reconciliation, budget consolidation, and management reporting workflows, significantly reducing processing time and manual error rates.
- › Delivered across a complex, multi-stakeholder environment with tight regulatory and operational constraints.

AI in Government Readiness | Civica · Central Government

- › Led pre-sales and PoC delivery for AI readiness assessments across central government departments.
- › Delivered actionable AI strategies identifying priority automations and the gaps needed to accelerate safe deployment.

SKILLS

AI & Agents: LLM orchestration, agentic workflow design, RAG pipelines, MCP protocol, human-in-the-loop systems, vector search, prompt engineering, coding assistants (Claude Code, OpenAI Codex)

Automation: Process automation, workflow design, API orchestration, intelligent document processing, RPA integration

Solution Architecture: End-to-end architecture design across enterprise AI, integration, and finance systems — from requirements and cost modelling through to hybrid-cloud deployment and go-live.

Integration & APIs: REST APIs, event-driven architectures, hybrid-cloud integration, SnapLogic, enterprise middleware

Languages: Python, SQL, Java, C++, Unix/CMD, Javascript, TypeScript

Data & Governance: Data security, regulatory compliance & reporting, audit trail, information governance, data lineage

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science · University College London (UCL) | AI Society

BSc Tonmeister — Music & Sound Recording · University of Surrey